MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer transitioning toward DevOps and platform engineering, with 7 years of experience including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD and test infrastructure. Owns merge-request ephemeral environments used by three product teams. Experienced with Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments, with personal hands-on practice in k3s, GitOps and Terraform. Brings an analytical approach to improving pipeline performance and reliability. Owned GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and wrote the internal CI guide used in onboarding.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal projects), Kubernetes (namespace-level access; basic), k3s, Argo CD

Monitoring & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Languages & Scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Systems & Tools: Linux, Git, Ansible (basic)

Cloud & Infrastructure Projects: AWS EC2 and S3 fundamentals (personal free-tier use); Hetzner VPS (personal project); Terraform (personal projects)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), coordinating build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, artifact publishing, and pipeline improvements across the teams.
- Profiled and improved CI pipelines across three teams.
- Own merge-request ephemeral environments used by three product teams.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of about 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Owned CI test-result reporting and flaky-test visibility for three product teams.
- Write Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal 2024–2025

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform as a personal project; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health 2023–2024

- Delivered short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments with seeded data, deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against each environment.

- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health 2023

- Collected CI test results using Python and the GitLab API, stored results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards for flaky tests by team.
- Helped teams identify top offenders as the flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1%.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation — exam scheduled for January 2027; not yet certified.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)